



FOSTER

Consulting and Business
Development Center

Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen Final Presentation

Foster Consulting Program

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Business Impact Group

OUR TEAM



- 01** Project Overview
- 02** S W O T Analysis
- 03** Recommendations
- 04** Implementation Timeline
- 05** Q&A



PROJECT OVERVIEW

Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen

local farmers and
artisans as suppliers



The Story

Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen (GCGK), founded by Tina Fahnbulleh in 2016, specializes in traditional West African cuisine, gaining popularity through catering and pop-up events in Seattle. In opening its first permanent location, GCGK aims to capitalize on the absence of West African cuisine in the Seattle market by emphasizing authentic recipes and spice blends, with a focus on building a defined brand image across social media platforms and addressing hiring concerns for its lean culinary team.

Operations at a Glance

4

FOH: Servers, Bartenders,
Runner/Busser

3

BOH: Cooks and Prep
*including Tina

1

Marketing Manager
*ONLY Tina

The Goal

Streamline and alleviate operational and marketing challenges to enable Tina to focus on her core priority – delivering the finest food and enhancing the in-house dining experience.

Project Scope



Online Visibility and Presence



- Search Engine Optimization (SEO)
- Online Directories
- Instagram: Driving Organic Traffic

Local Marketing Opportunities



- Email Marketing
- B2B Catering
- University Catering
- Online Articles
- Food Influencers

Feedback & Improvement



- Employee Training and Satisfaction
- Post-Dining GCGK Experience



SWOT Analysis

SWOT Analysis



STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
❖ Unique identity ❖ Focus on high quality service ❖ Woman-owned business ❖ Lack of immediate competitors in local area	❖ Absence of cohesive brand identity and marketing plan ❖ Transitioning from pop-up model to traditional restaurant model ❖ Supply chain reliance on imported goods
OPPORTUNITY	THREATS
❖ Untapped market potential for West African foods ❖ Trend: Growing interest in diverse foods ❖ Community building, providing an authentic cultural experience	❖ Limited awareness and perception challenges for African food and culture ❖ Lack of easily obtainable low-cost African ingredients ❖ Relatively low traffic area



Recommendations



Search Engine Optimization (SEO) Online Directories



SEO: Directories



What do we look for in a Restaurant Directory to maximize GCGK's visibility?



High Directory Traffic



High Time Spent



Low Cost

Allmenus



Overview

- **Purpose:** Menu posting only
- Owned by GrubHub

Key Facts

- High Bounce Rate for Viewers¹
- 1.6 million users in past month

Implement

- Free to Post Menu
- To Add: <https://www.allmenus.com/contact-us/>

¹Bounce Rate: % of visitors who leave a website without taking an action

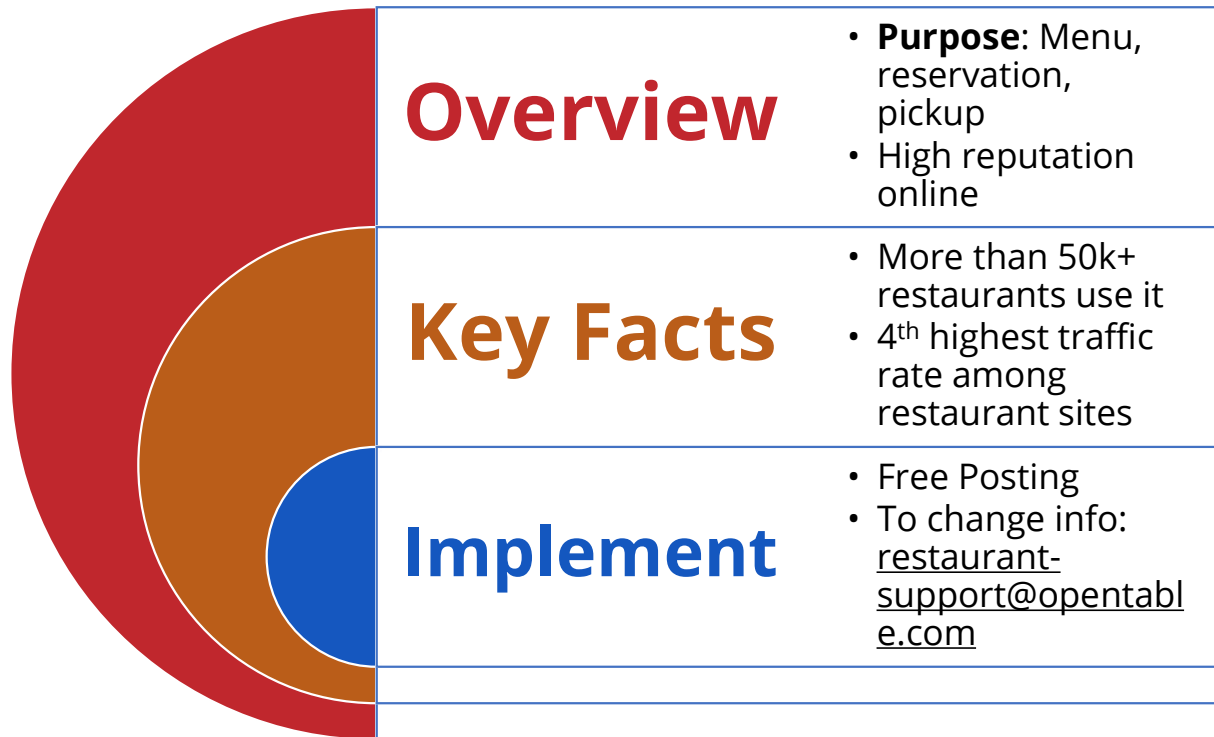
Why #3

Industry average monthly user total

GrubHub integration in the Future

Free Menu Posting

OpenTable



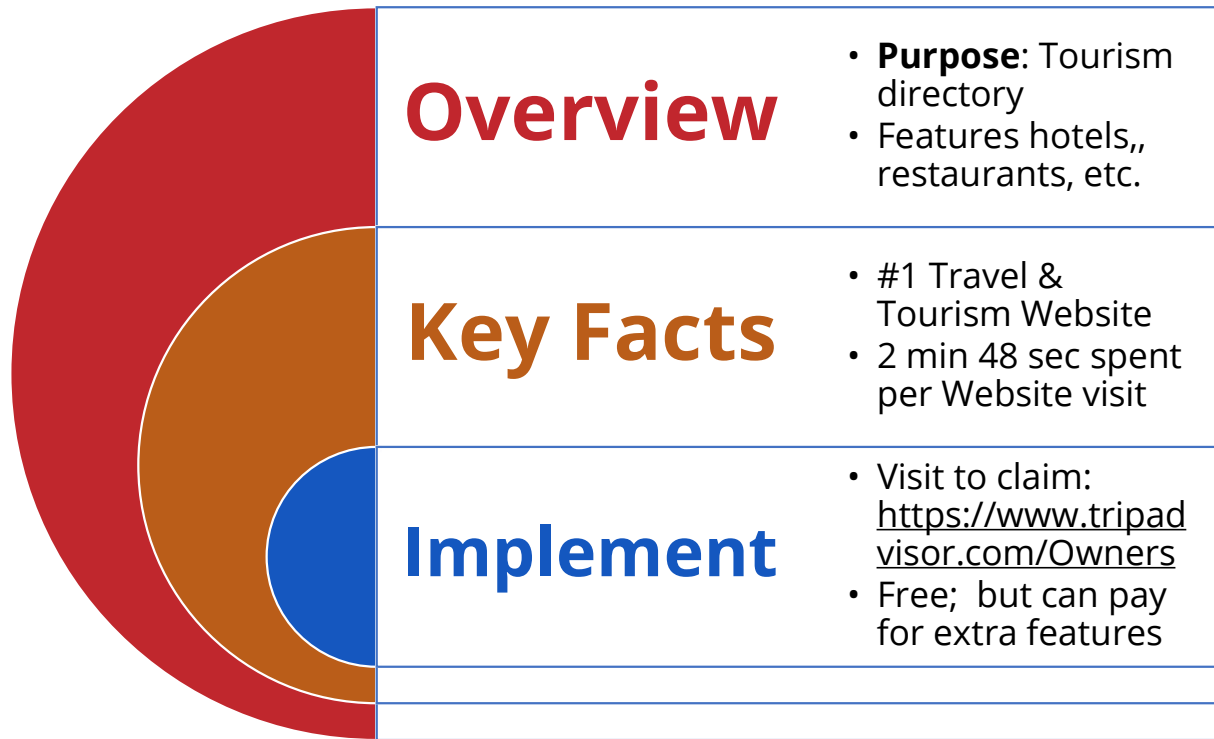
Why #2

High Traffic Rate

Proven Reputation and Usage + Expansion

Free Menu Posting

TripAdvisor



Why #1

Icon in the Tourism/Travel Industry

High User Time Spent

Free to Claim Your Business

Additional Considerations



Why Not Yelp...Yet?:

- Risk of Negativity
- High Effort Upkeep
- Not Client Focus Now

When Will Yelp be the Right Move?:

- Once Post-Dining Survey Feedback is Incorporated
- Additional personnel hired (Media Manager)
- If wrong information is posted online*

Visit
biz.yelp.com/claim
When Ready To
Begin The Process

Create Yelp
Business Account

Edit and Upkeep
Page Freely



Driving Organic Traffic Instagram



Geo Tags and Keywords

Recommendation:

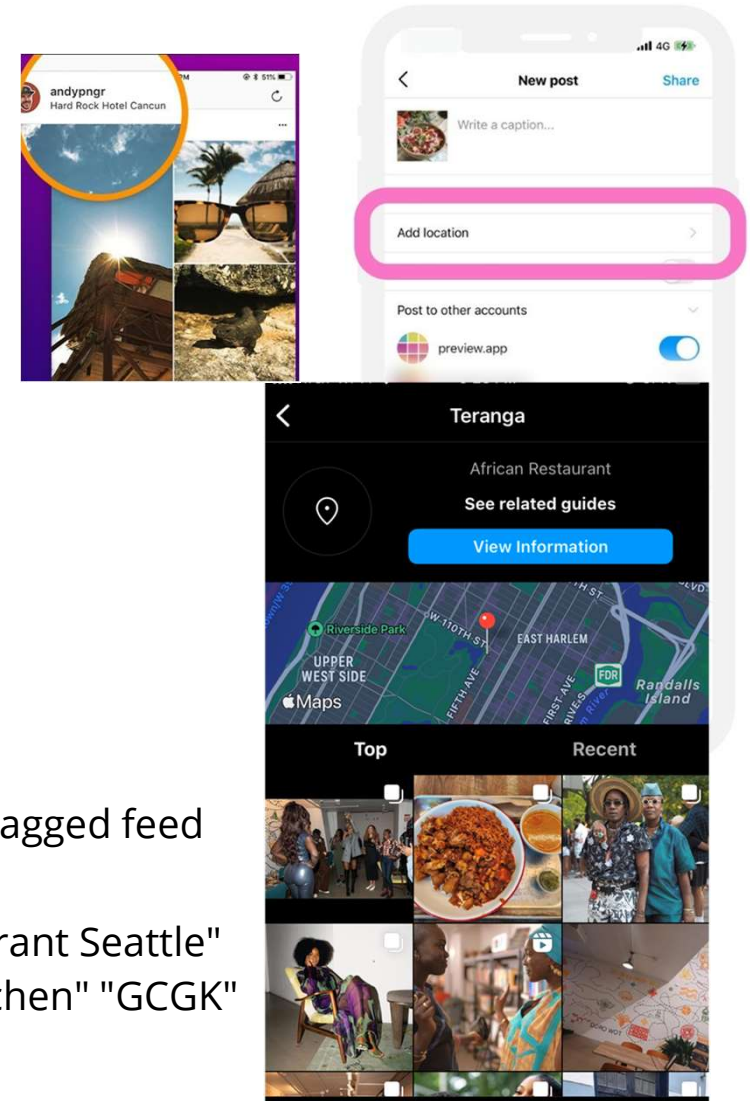
Tag your restaurant's location in posts and stories

Purpose:

- Helps business discovery when they searching for nearby places.
- Showcases food, ambience, location, and social proof

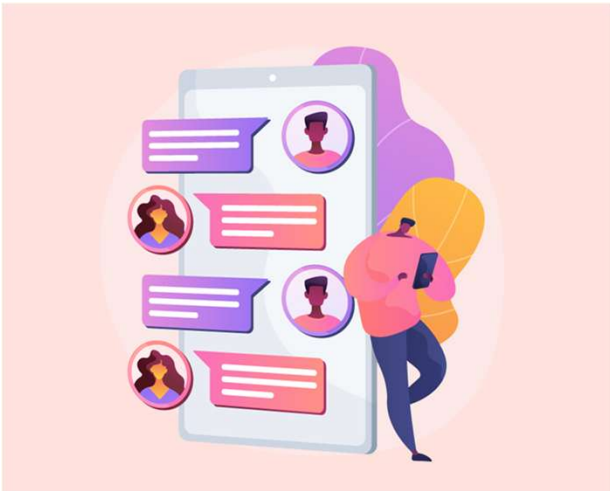
Implementation

- Claim Business on Instagram [Step by Step](#)
- Tagging @goldcoastghalkitchen on own posts to show in location tagged feed
- Keywords in captions or hashtags
 - Location based: "Seattle African cuisine", "West African restaurant Seattle"
 - Niche/Branded: "MeatPies", "WestAfrican" "GoldCoastGhalKitchen" "GCGK"





Increasing Patron Engagement



Recommendation:

- Respond to comments & DMs promptly
- Encourage customer photos, posting, and tagging GCGK
- Utilize Stories and Highlights with personable content

Purpose:

- Makes customer relation feel important
- Curate narrative using social proof
- Add value to customer feeds

Implementation:

- Block 15 minutes per day to respond to comments and DMs
- Snap photos, tag restaurant, post to story, save to highlight

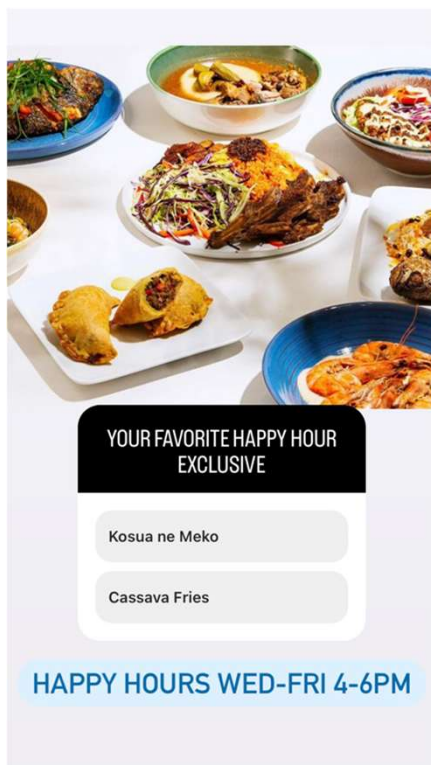
Tips:

- Add location sticker or website sticker on stories for patrons to find more info

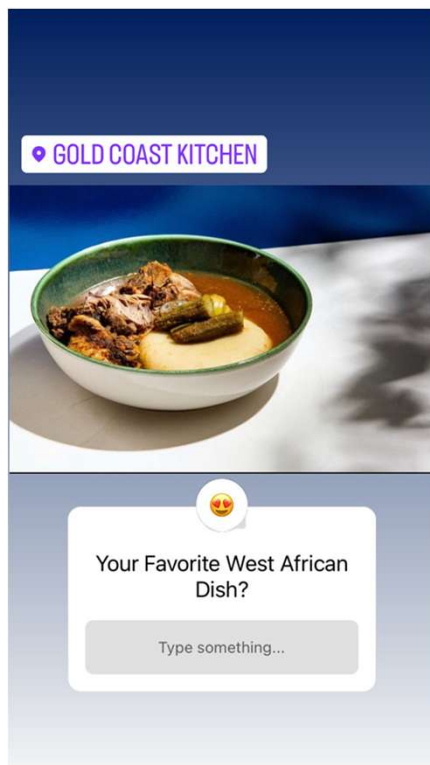
Engagement Examples



Polls



Questions



Add Value



Overview

Polls

- Engage and gain customer feedback

Questions

- Engage and gain customer preferences

Add Value

- Educate about brand, story, and give reason for customer to watch stories

More Examples in Appendix

Leveraging User Generated Content



Story Repost Example

User Generated Content (UGC):

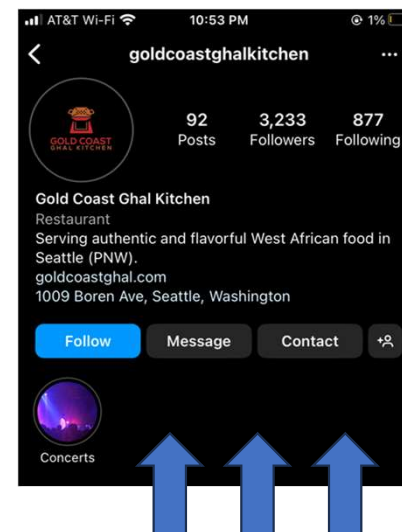
- Encourage patrons to post photos
- Repost Photos on Stories and save them in highlights **OR**
- Ask patrons to be included in GCGK photos to control feed quality

Purpose:

- Build connection and trust with patrons
- Social proof of restaurant success
- Engages audiences with personable faces

Implementation:

- Repost within 24 hours of patron's post
- Snap photos of patrons and tag them on stories
- Save content in appropriate highlight



Highlight Ideas

- Brand Story
- Our Patrons
- Process
- Educational (foods/culture)
- Past Events
- Article Features

Organic Traffic on Instagram Summary



	Geo-Tags/Keywords	Engagement	User Generated Content
Type	Tagging restaurant location each story and post; Tagging collabs	Respond to DMs, reviews, positive comments; Polls, Questions, Stories to add value for patrons	Repost Stories & Posts (own and tagged); encourage pictures and tag patrons
Purpose	Reach markets, showcase restaurant	Build customer relations, increase satisfaction	Community Engagement, increase social proof
Time & Frequency	5 minutes/post [20 min set up]	15 minutes once/day	Block out 10 min to repost stories or in own time



Local Marketing Strategy and Recommendations





Email Marketing and Square

Email marketing is a powerful way to engage with customers. Establishing an opt-in email list can keep customers engaged with Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen over time.

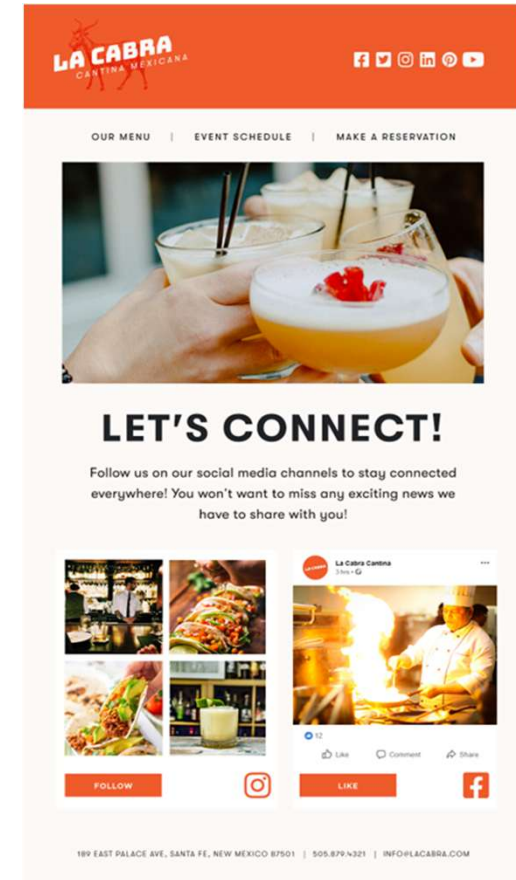
Opportunities for Growth

Email Marketing generates **\$36** for every **\$1** spent

Automated campaigns have a **1.7x** higher open rate and **2.3x** higher coupon redemption rate than one-off email blasts

Features offered through Square Email Marketing

- Email Lists
- Automated Email campaigns
- Email designer with templates



Square Email Marketing



Pricing with Square (Based on number of subscribers to email list)

Number of Subscribed Customers	Monthly Cost
Up to 500	\$15
501 - 1,000	\$30
1,001 - 2,000	\$40
2,001+	See more pricing options

Automating Campaigns

[<](#) Design

3. Audience & Send

Activate

Who do you want to reach?

Once you activate this campaign, it will be sent to qualifying customers automatically. You can stop this campaign at any time from your marketing dashboard.

Customers after their first visit

This campaign will be sent to customers who have visited your business for the first time. They will receive this email within 24 hours of their first visit.

Reminder

If the email is not opened, resend the email 5 days after the original delivery date. Also, send a reminder 7 days before the coupon expires.

☒ Enabled

Send yourself a preview of your email.

[youremail@gmail.com >](#)



Your Business Name

Thanks for visiting!

We hope you enjoyed your first visit to our store. Here is a special discount to use the next time you come in. We would love to see you again soon!

B2B Catering



Business to business (B2B) catering entails catering to local business. B2B food service is a market segment that caters for business events including company events, meetings, daily offices lunches and more. Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen has the opportunity to connect with decision makers at local business to enhance visibility and build long term relationships.

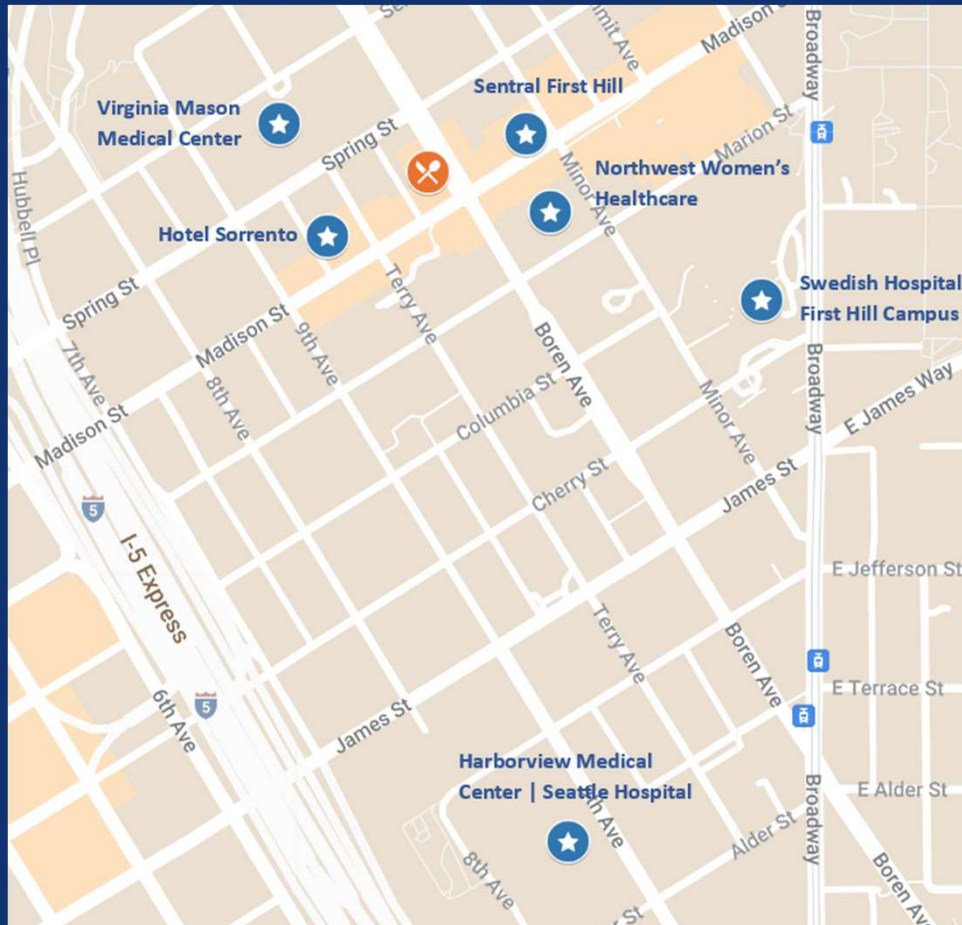
Opportunities for Growth

71% of decision makers and **91%** of medical representatives order at least once a month

48% of caterers report corporate events were their largest area of growth in 2022

Take advantage of First Hill's local features

- Virginia Mason Medical Center
- Swedish Hospital – First Hill Campus
- Harborview Medical Center | Seattle Hospital
- Northwest Women's Healthcare
- Hotel Sorrento



University Club Collaborations



Collaborating with local university cultural or culinary clubs offers a unique avenue for Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen to expand potential customer base. By engaging with these groups, we can tap into a vibrant community of potential patrons who, while not initially within our target demographic, are often active during our extended evening hours, providing an excellent opportunity to increase our nighttime footfall and diversify our clientele.



Targeted Marketing



Community Ties



Menu and Brand Enhancement

University Club Collaborations



Criteria / Club	UW African Student Association	UW Husky Culinary Club	Seattle U Black Student Union
Targeted Marketing	High	Medium	High
Community Ties	High	Medium	High
Menu and Brand Enhancement	High	Medium (Broader culinary feedback)	High
Cultural Alignment with Restaurant	High	Low	High
Potential for New Customer	High	Medium (Culinary enthusiasts)	High
Alignment with Extended Hours	High	Medium	High
Opportunity for Cultural Events	High	Low	Medium
Visibility and Reach	Medium	High	Medium

Online Articles



The online article serves as a powerful tool in restaurant marketing by significantly boosting brand visibility and credibility, engaging a wide audience with compelling content that highlights the restaurant's unique qualities and offerings.



Merges storytelling and visuals for Gen X and Millennials' preferences.



Builds trust and authenticity through established media channels.



Strengthens digital marketing for a cohesive marketing strategy.



Online Articles – Decision Matrix



Criteria / Platform	Seattle Times' Restaurant Reviews	Seattle Times' Food & Drink Section	Eater Seattle
Target Audience Match	Older demographic (Local Diners)	Older demographic (Residents and Visitors)	Mixed demographic (Foodies and Culinary Explorers)
Focus on Local Dining	High	High	High
Cultural Appeal	Medium (Cuisine and Ambiance)	Low (Home Cooking and Recipes)	High (Diverse Cuisine and Food Culture)
Storytelling Aspect	High (Chef and Restaurant Stories)	Medium (Community and Events)	High (Food Culture and Traditions)
Visual Appeal	Medium	High (High-quality images)	High (Visual Storytelling Style)
Opportunity for Unique Selling Points	High (Unique Selling Points)	Low (More focused on recipes)	High (Trendy and New Establishments)
Instagram Account	Yes	Yes	Yes

Social Media Marketing Strategy



Visual Engagement and Community Interaction:

- Showcase high-quality visuals of the restaurant's offerings.
- Engage with the audience through comments, featuring user content, and influencer partnerships.

Data-Driven Personalization:

- Use analytics for targeted advertising and content optimization.
- Utilize tags on food and culture

Leveraging Established Follower Bases:

- Utilize accounts with large followings for enhanced reach and visibility.
- Collaborate for exclusive content and promotions to engage these audiences.

Social Media Marketing Strategy



Criteria / Account	@seattle.food.diva	@seattlefoodscene	@seattle.grub	@visitseattle	@eaterseattle
Follower Count	141k	32k	35.4k	184k	65k
Content Focus	Broad Food Content	Broad Food Content	Broad Food Content	Seattle Travel	Seattle Black Businesses
Engagement Quality	High	Medium	Medium	High	High
Local Influence	High	High	High	High	High
Potential for Catering Partnerships	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium



Tasting Trends: Exploring Survey Analytics



Why Surveys?



Employees and Customers

- Gain valuable insights
- Understand decision-making factors
- See a different perspective



Data-Driven Decisions

- Base business decisions in data
- Understand customer preferences
- Determine market expectations



Brand Loyalty

- Build stronger relationships
- Empower employees
- Encourage WOM recommendations

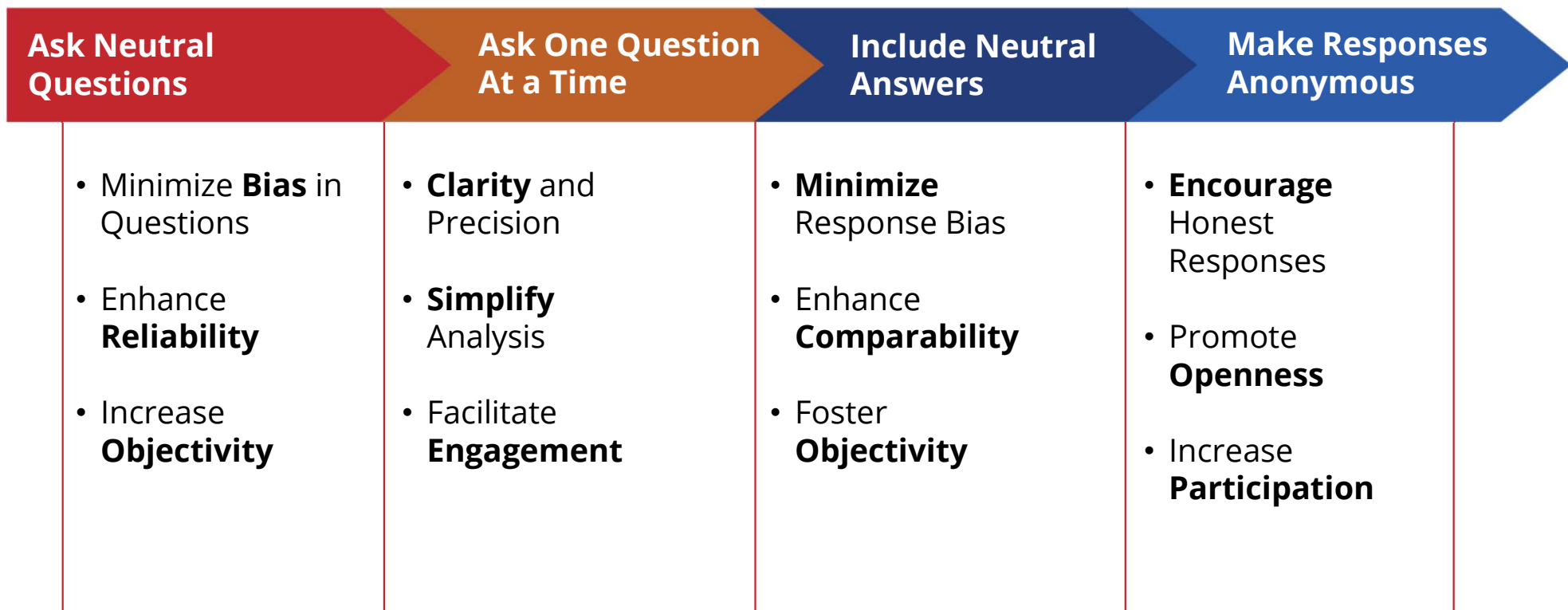


Customer Engagement

- Improve customer satisfaction
- Incorporate addressable feedback
- Show commitment to improvement



Building a Survey



Building a Survey - Examples



Ask Neutral Questions

How satisfied or dissatisfied are you with your working conditions?

How happy are you with your working conditions?



Ask One Question at a Time

1. How was your overall service tonight?

and

2. How was your food tonight?

How was your overall service and food tonight?



Employee Survey



Purpose

- Obtain **feedback** from employees
- See operations from an **inside angle**
- Employee **retention**

Data

- Focus on **qualitative** data
- Opportunities for **growth** and reflection
- Find any **gaps** in training or operations

Delivery

- **1 month** after new employees complete training
- Send survey to **tenured employees** ASAP
- Utilize **current communication channels**





Customer (Post-Dining) Survey

Purpose

- Obtain **feedback** from customers
- See operations from a **consumer angle**
- Customer **retention**

Data

- **Quantitative** and **qualitative**
- Overall satisfaction, **service**, and loyalty
- Open ended, room for **feedback**

Delivery

- **QR Code** on receipt
- **Personally** delivered to customers after their meal
- Accurate data, **fresh in minds**

Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen
Experience Survey

1. How satisfied or dissatisfied were you with your experience at Gold Coast Ghal Kitchen? [📄]

☐ Very satisfied

☐ Somewhat satisfied

☐ Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied

☐ Somewhat dissatisfied

☐ Very dissatisfied

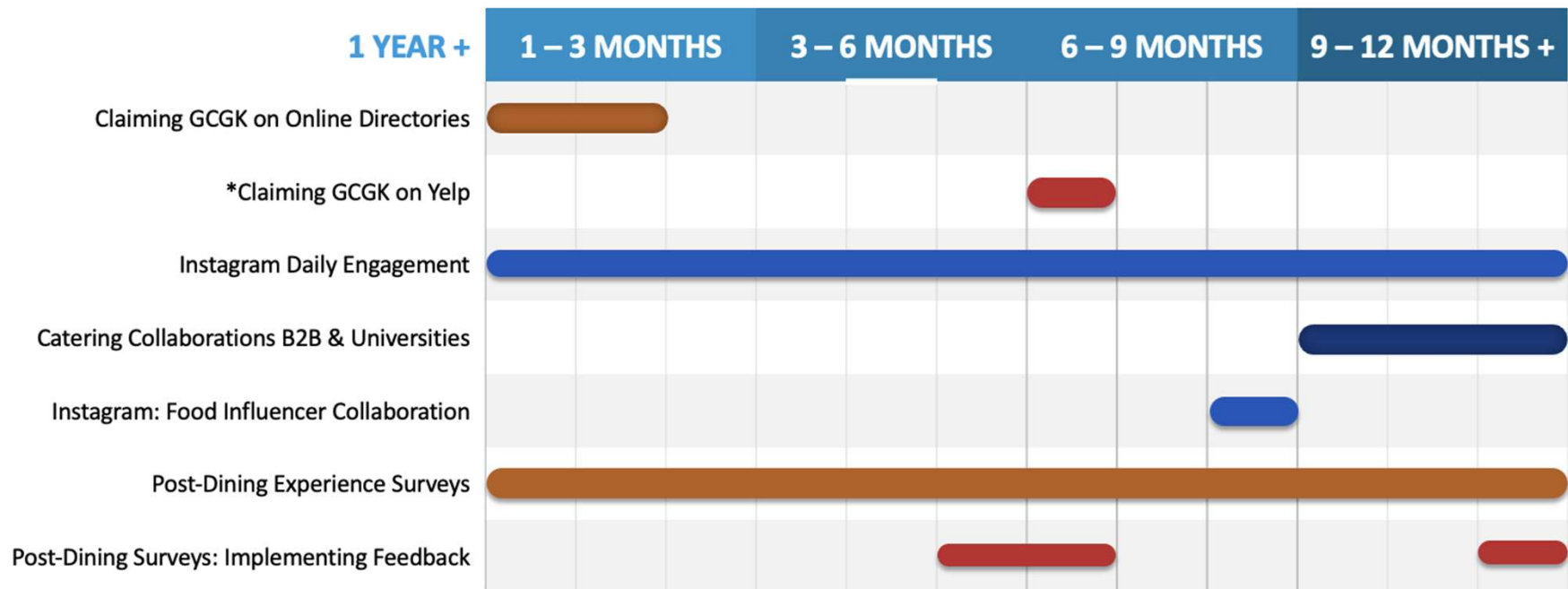
2. What was the most significant factor influencing your response to the previous question? [📄]

Enter your answer

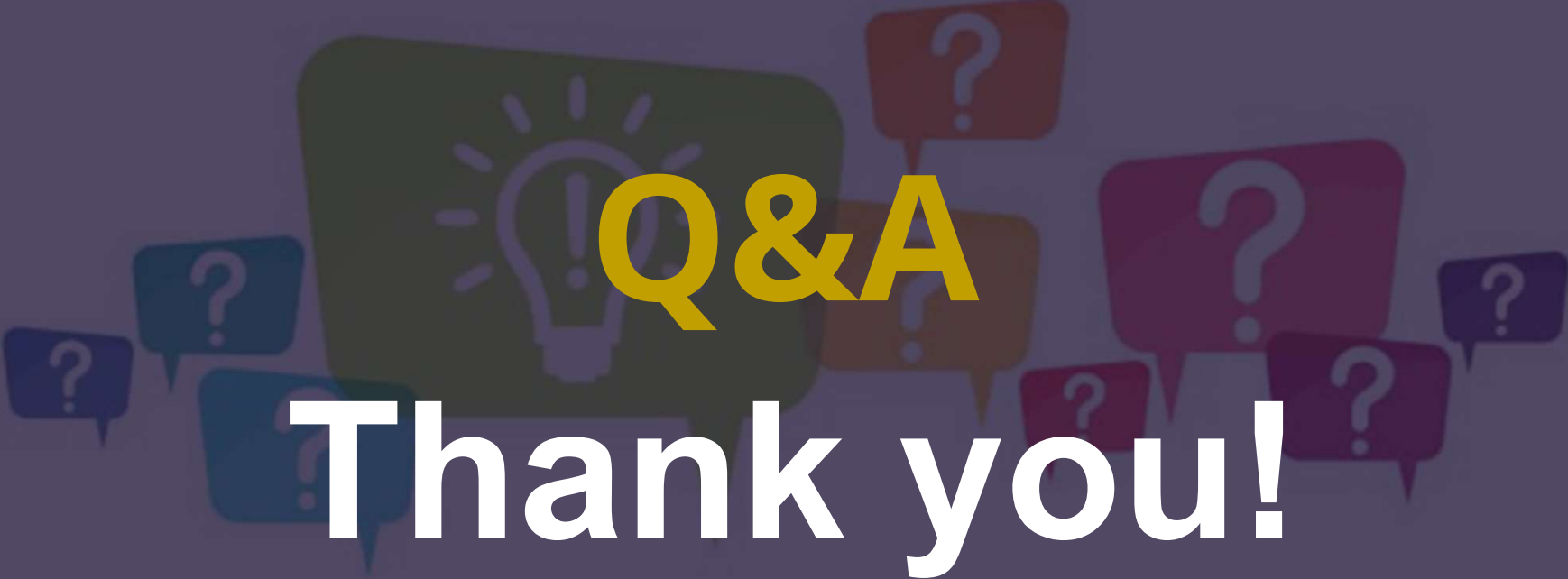


Implementation Timeline

Implementation Timeline



Note: The Employee Training and Experience Survey is not included in the timeline as it is given to each employee 1 month after hiring and training is complete.



Q&A

Thank you!